

Participant Information Sheet

Project title:	Studying Experiences with Data Representations of a Collection of Edinburgh-related Literature
Principal investigator:	Uta Hinrichs
Researcher collecting data:	Merritt Wang
Funder (if applicable):	N/A

This study was certified according to the Informatics Research Ethics Process, reference number 446635. Please take time to read the following information carefully. You should keep this page for your records.

Who are the researchers?

This research conducted by Merritt Wang as part of their MSc project at the School of Informatics, University of Edinburgh. The MSc project is supervised by Dr. Uta Hinrichs, Reader in Data Visualization at the School of Informatics.

What is the purpose of the study?

This MSc project focuses utilizing data representations (e.g., data visualizations or physicalizations to make a collection of Edinburgh-related literature explorable from different perspectives. As part of this study we would like to explore people's interest in the data and their experiences of bespoke data representation.

Why have I been asked to take part?

You have been asked to take part in this study as you live in Edinburgh, have indicated an interest in Edinburgh-related literature, and/or have expressed an interest in this project. Your participation in this study will help us design and refine relevant data representations to make this collection of Edinburgh-related literature explorable by a wide range of audiences.

Do I have to take part?

No – participation in this study is entirely up to you. You can withdraw from the study at any time, up until **7 days after your study session** without giving a reason. After this point, personal data will be deleted and anonymised data will be combined such



that it is impossible to remove individual information from the analysis. Your rights will not be affected. If you wish to withdraw, contact the PI – Dr. Uta Hinrichs (uhinrich@ed.ac.uk). We will keep copies of your original consent, and of your withdrawal request.

What will happen if I decide to take part?

You will first be asked to complete a short background questionnaire about your interest in or experience with Edinburgh-related literature and/or data visualisation (approx. 5 min.). You will then be introduced to several data visualisations representing Edinburgh-related literature and asked to complete a small number of tasks based on them (for example, identifying which author a visualisation belongs to, or judging the relationship between places), followed by a short reflection questionnaire about your experience. Your task responses and questionnaire answers will be recorded in writing; no audio or video recording will take place. The full session should take approx. 30-40 min. to complete.

Are there any risks associated with taking part?

There are no significant risks associated with participation.

Are there any benefits associated with taking part?

There are no direct benefits for participating in these study activities, other than learning about Edinburgh-related literature and getting the opportunity of informing ways of exploring it.

Refreshments will be provided for in-person study activities.

What will happen to the results of this study?

The results of this study may be summarised in published articles, reports and presentations. Quotes or key findings will be anonymized: We will remove any information that could, in our assessment, allow anyone to identify you. With your consent, information can also be used for future research. Your data may be archived for a maximum of 4 years. All potentially identifiable data will be deleted within this timeframe if it has not already been deleted as part of anonymization.



Data protection and confidentiality.

Your data will be processed in accordance with Data Protection Law. All information collected about you will be kept strictly confidential. Your data will be referred to by a unique participant number rather than by name. Your data will only be viewed by the researcher/research team named on this PIS.

All electronic data will be stored on a password-protected encrypted computer, on the School of Informatics' secure file servers, or on the University's secure encrypted cloud storage services (DataShare, ownCloud, or Sharepoint) and all paper records will be stored in a locked filing cabinet in the PI's office. Your consent information will be kept separately from your responses in order to minimise risk.

What are my data protection rights?

The University of Edinburgh is a Data Controller for the information you provide. You have the right to access information held about you. Your right of access can be exercised in accordance Data Protection Law. You also have other rights including rights of correction, erasure and objection. For more details, including the right to lodge a complaint with the Information Commissioner's Office, please visit www.ico.org.uk. Questions, comments and requests about your personal data can also be sent to the University Data Protection Officer at dpo@ed.ac.uk.

Who can I contact?

If you have any further questions about the study, please contact the lead researcher, Uta Hinrichs (uhinrich@ed.ac.uk).

If you wish to make a complaint about the study, please contact inf-ethics@inf.ed.ac.uk. When you contact us, please provide the study title and detail the nature of your complaint.

Alternative formats.

To request this document in an alternative format, such as large print or on coloured paper, please contact Uta Hinrichs (uhinrich@ed.ac.uk).

General information.



For general information about how we use your data, go to: [Privacy notice |
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